

frequency. Digital recording differs however, in that the recording happens in steps and not as a continuous process. The amplitude and frequency are recorded at each step and then these steps stitched together form the entire audio file. It goes without saying therefore, that the closer the steps are, the smoother is the audio recording. From a user's perspective, the fundamental difference between digital and analog editing, however, is non-destructive editing of the files – files that can be edited without losing data wherever adjustments are required.

There are primarily two types of software that deal with audio: Digital Audio Workstations (DAWs) and Digital Audio Editors (DAEs). While DAWs are complete recording and production systems, DAEs are less complex versions that focus only on editing files after recording them. However, the difference between the two has been blurring with DAEs offering a lot of features that DAWs have traditionally been known to offer. Therefore, we're going to bunch them together and call them DAS (Digital Audio Software).

Sound is such an important part of our daily life experience that every individual and business would do well to know how to effectively use digital audio software. Adding audio to your website or advertisement, or creating podcasts are effective ways to grow businesses. For simple users, audio editors allow us to do things like make flawless YouTube videos and create mesmerising ringtones of our choice, among other things.

Although the gap between feature sets in proprietary and open source software is decreasing, it's still quite a while before they will overlap. Some of the popular digital audio workstations are pretty expensive, and with good reason. Let's first talk about the marquee proprietary software that are now available in the market.

PROPRIETARY FEATURE-RICH SOFTWARE

Ableton Live

Platform: OS X, Windows

Cost: \$600 (₹38,088) - Basic version, \$950 (₹60,306) - Standard version and \$1,200 (₹76,177) - Suite version

Ableton Live isn't just a standard music editing program. It's a powerful DAW and is more suited to live music recording, composing and mastering your music. Ableton has an enormous set of features and supports virtually any type of audio. The features specifically cater to live musicians, but its beat-matching technology and other turntable-related features make it an application DJs enjoy as well. In the session view, any audio or MIDI loop